SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

14 July 2022 · Shift 1

69 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 31 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Bulky

(A) Airy
(B) Soft
(C) Massive
(D) Scanty

Q.2

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. “Hardly had he disappeared that her mother” clomped down the steps, looking for him.

(A) Hardly did he disappeared that her mother
(B) Hardly had he disappear that her mother
(C) No improvement required
(D) Hardly had he disappeared when her mother

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. My friend is not _____ for this complicated assignment.

(A) worthy
(B) comfortable
(C) suitable
(D) entitled

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. But if you _____ to spare before you do catch the bus, be sure to pop in.

(A) have a meeting
(B) have a moment
(C) have a nap
(D) have a ride

Q.5

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence.In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. Michael nodded and “begun writing at” his pad.

(A) begun to write in
(B) begin writing in
(C) began writing on
(D) No improvement required

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. Just try and recall the poor people you “saw on the” streets, on local trains, and in slums on our way back.

(A) have been seen on the
(B) seen on the
(C) have seeing on the
(D) No substitution required

Q.7

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. An unidentified man on "an bike dropped for" the box outside the building.

(A) a bike dropped off
(B) a bike dropping for
(C) a bike drop of
(D) No improvement required

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Maestro

(A) Genius
(B) Senile
(C) Slender
(D) Novice

Q.9

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. My mother exclaimed / at how fast / the days had pass.

(A) at how fast
(B) No error
(C) My mother exclaimed
(D) the days had pass

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To raise a dust

(A) To meet one's defeat
(B) To be satisfied with what you have achieved
(C) To be secretly or inwardly amused
(D) To cause disruption or confusion

Q.11

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. "She had no sooner taken a few steps forward that" she suddenly recoiled.

(A) No sooner had she taken a few steps forward than
(B) She did no sooner taken a few steps forward than
(C) No improvement required
(D) She did no sooner took a few steps forward than

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. One day, the queen was painting when a messenger entered _____ to convey the king's arrival.

(A) comparably
(B) relatively
(C) enjoyably
(D) breathlessly

Q.13

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Hundreds of migrants work in private firms in Erode.

(A) firms in Erode
(B) No error
(C) Hundreds of migrants
(D) work in private

Q.14

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. "Can all us" sleep in the same room, Mother?

(A) May all we
(B) Can we all
(C) Should us all
(D) No improvement required

Q.15

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Neither she not I am going to take part in the debate competition.

(A) am going to take part
(B) No error
(C) Neither she not I
(D) in the debate competition

Q.16

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Hieght
(B) Beleive
(C) Fiery
(D) Foriegn

Q.17

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Strangled
(B) Dominion
(C) Solitory
(D) Persecution

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. You really need to exercise daily, if you want to live a long and _____ life.

(A) marginal
(B) shrieking
(C) wealthy
(D) healthy

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. That lady must "have an axe to grind" that's why she is not reporting your crime.

(A) To have a tedious job
(B) To have a crucial information
(C) To delay one's actions
(D) To have an ulterior motive

Q.20

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Unfeigned

(A) Sincere
(B) Genuine
(C) Pretended
(D) Expressive

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When he died on 27 November 1953, Gladstone O'Neill was (1) _____ recognised as one of the major dramatists of the modern world. Four times a Pulitzer Prize-winner, he had also been (2) _____ the 1936 Nobel Prize for Literature. His plays have been translated into most major languages and read by more people than those of (3) _____ other playwright except W Shakespeare and maybe G Bernard Shaw. O'Neill was a puzzle to his friends – a genuinely shy, brooding, complicated man in whom (4) _____ alternated with touching kindness. He was both, naive and worldly. One biographer found him "sentimental one instant, hard as nails the next." His widow, after 26 years with O'Neill, said, "To (5) _____ his work you must understand the man, for the work and the man are one."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) manically
(B) universally
(C) specifically
(D) casually

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When he died on 27 November 1953, Gladstone O'Neill was (1) _____ recognised as one of the major dramatists of the modern world. Four times a Pulitzer Prize-winner, he had also been (2) _____ the 1936 Nobel Prize for Literature. His plays have been translated into most major languages and read by more people than those of (3) _____ other playwright except W Shakespeare and maybe G Bernard Shaw. O'Neill was a puzzle to his friends – a genuinely shy, brooding, complicated man in whom (4) _____ alternated with touching kindness. He was both, naive and worldly. One biographer found him "sentimental one instant, hard as nails the next." His widow, after 26 years with O'Neill, said, "To (5) _____ his work you must understand the man, for the work and the man are one."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) rewarded
(B) awarded
(C) unaided
(D) crowded

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When he died on 27 November 1953, Gladstone O'Neill was (1) _____ recognised as one of the major dramatists of the modern world. Four times a Pulitzer Prize-winner, he had also been (2) _____ the 1936 Nobel Prize for Literature. His plays have been translated into most major languages and read by more people than those of (3) _____ other playwright except W Shakespeare and maybe G Bernard Shaw. O'Neill was a puzzle to his friends – a genuinely shy, brooding, complicated man in whom (4) _____ alternated with touching kindness. He was both, naive and worldly. One biographer found him "sentimental one instant, hard as nails the next." His widow, after 26 years with O'Neill, said, "To (5) _____ his work you must understand the man, for the work and the man are one."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) none
(B) few
(C) any
(D) some

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When he died on 27 November 1953, Gladstone O'Neill was (1) _____ recognised as one of the major dramatists of the modern world. Four times a Pulitzer Prize-winner, he had also been (2) _____ the 1936 Nobel Prize for Literature. His plays have been translated into most major languages and read by more people than those of (3) _____ other playwright except W Shakespeare and maybe G Bernard Shaw. O'Neill was a puzzle to his friends – a genuinely shy, brooding, complicated man in whom (4) _____ alternated with touching kindness. He was both, naive and worldly. One biographer found him "sentimental one instant, hard as nails the next." His widow, after 26 years with O'Neill, said, "To (5) _____ his work you must understand the man, for the work and the man are one."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) failure
(B) success
(C) benefit
(D) cruelty

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When he died on 27 November 1953, Gladstone O'Neill was (1) _____ recognised as one of the major dramatists of the modern world. Four times a Pulitzer Prize-winner, he had also been (2) _____ the 1936 Nobel Prize for Literature. His plays have been translated into most major languages and read by more people than those of (3) _____ other playwright except W Shakespeare and maybe G Bernard Shaw. O'Neill was a puzzle to his friends – a genuinely shy, brooding, complicated man in whom (4) _____ alternated with touching kindness. He was both, naive and worldly. One biographer found him "sentimental one instant, hard as nails the next." His widow, after 26 years with O'Neill, said, "To (5) _____ his work you must understand the man, for the work and the man are one."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) prepare
(B) produce
(C) understand
(D) demonstrate

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

What will be the value of the following expression, if '×' and '–' are interchanged and '+' and '÷' are interchanged? 200 ÷ 100 × 300 ÷ 200 + 10 – 2 × 40 = ?

(A) 200
(B) 2
(C) 40
(D) 0

Q.3

Which two numbers need to be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 27 – 8 × 4 – 3 ÷ 2 = 1

(A) 2 and 8
(B) 2 and 3
(C) 3 and 4
(D) 8 and 4

Q.4

In a certain code language, 'heart black blue' is written as '8 # ab', 'grey are blue' is written as '# pr kt'. How will 'blue' be written in that language?

(A) ab
(B) pr
(C) #
(D) 8

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. TACKLE : TCCMLG :: JACKET : JCCMEV :: NEPTUNE : ?

(A) PEPTVOE
(B) PERTWNG
(C) NFGPVUP
(D) NGPVUPE

Q.6

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given set. (7, 49, 343)

(A) (5, 25, 625)
(B) (11, 121, 1321)
(C) (13, 169, 2197)
(D) (3, 9, 29)

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. Virat Kohli : Cricket :: Saina Nehwal : Badminton :: Viswanathan Anand : ?

(A) Basketball
(B) Chess
(C) Tennis
(D) Football

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. LOB : DQN :: HER : ?

(A) TGK
(B) TGJ
(C) JGU
(D) JGT

Q.11

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 524, 533, 544, 557, ?

(A) 574
(B) 568
(C) 572
(D) 564

Q.13

The marks of seven students A, B, C, D, E, F and G in a test were given as follows: A's score was exactly between E's and F's scores. B's score was more than only G's score. C's score was immediately more than B's score. F's score was more than E's score and F did not score the highest. Who scored the highest marks in the test?

(A) A
(B) G
(C) E
(D) D

Q.14

In a certain code language, 'GRSTB' is written as 'GYXWL', and 'HANDS' is written as 'XISFM'. How will 'MNDET' be written in that language?

(A) YJITS
(B) YJIRS
(C) JIISR
(D) YJISR

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'GEFS' is written as 'HFER' and ‘IBIS’ is written as ‘JCHR’. How will 'STIR' be written in that language?

(A) RSHQ
(B) TUJS
(C) RUHS
(D) TUHQ

Q.17

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. Some M are Q. II. All V are Q. Conclusions: I. Some Q are M. II. No M is V.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.18

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All hexagons are pentagons. All pentagons are octagons. All octagons are decagons. Conclusions: I. All decagons are hexagons. II. All hexagons are octagons.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.19

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 28, 27, 31, 22, 38, 13, 49, ?

(A) 42
(B) 2
(C) 0
(D) 22

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'ACQUIRE' is written as 'QCAUERI', 'ADDRESS' is written as 'DDARSSE', and 'ABILITY' is written as 'IBALYTI'. How will 'ICEBERG' be written in that language?

(A) GREBECI
(B) GREBICE
(C) ECIBGRE
(D) ICEBGRE

Q.21

Five friends N, M, O, P and Q are sitting in a column facing east (but not necessarily in the same order) . O is sitting to the leftmost side. N is the immediate neighbour of M and Q. P is not sitting on any of the end seats. Who is the immediate neighbour of O?

(A) M
(B) Q
(C) P
(D) N

Q.23

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. AEI, EIO, IOU, ?

(A) UAE
(B) AEI
(C) OUA
(D) AII

Q.24

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 3 : 72 :: 21 : 504 :: 36 : ?

(A) 480
(B) 864
(C) 632
(D) 376

Q.25

Seven boys B1, B2, B3, B4, B5, B6 and B7 are sitting around a circular table facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). B1 is third to the left of B7. B4 is to immediate left of B1. B2 is second to the left of B6. B6 is not an immediate neighbour of B5. Who are the immediate neighbours of B3?

(A) B5 and B4
(B) B6 and B7
(C) B1 and B2
(D) B4 and B6

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which part of the Constitution of India talks about the Directive Principles of State Policy?

(A) Part IV
(B) Part V
(C) Part III
(D) Part II

Q.2

Who among the following was a famous Indian playback singer and an actor too?

(A) Kashinath Ghanekar
(B) Kishore Kumar
(C) Pranab Mukherjee
(D) Sunil Chhetri

Q.3

The Purple Revolution, which was launched in Jammu and Kashmir, is also known as _____.

(A) Lavender Revolution
(B) Indigo Revolution
(C) Orchids Revolution
(D) Lilac Revolution

Q.4

Who among the following founded Brahmo Samaj in Calcutta (Kolkata)?

(A) Swami Vivekanand
(B) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
(C) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(D) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

Q.5

Which of the following is NOT a cause of rural poverty in India?

(A) Migration from rural areas
(B) Lack of alternate employment opportunities other than agriculture
(C) Illiteracy
(D) Lack of capital

Q.6

Who is the Chairman of Financial Stability and Development Council (FSDC) of India?

(A) Finance Minister
(B) Human Resource Development Minister
(C) Home Minister
(D) Skill Development Minister

Q.7

The Great Indian Novel is written by the famous politician _____.

(A) Varun Gandhi
(B) Derek O'Brien
(C) AK Antony
(D) Shashi Tharoor

Q.8

Which of the given statements related to the temples of India is correct? I.The Nagara style of architecture is also known as the North Indian style; II.The Dravidian style of architecture is also known as the South Indian style.

(A) Neither I nor II
(B) Both I and II
(C) Only II
(D) Only I

Q.9
The uplifted blocks of block mountains are called _____.

(A) horsts
(B) grabens
(C) slopes
(D) cones

Q.10
Dantidurga belonged to which dynasty of India?

(A) Chalukya
(B) Chola
(C) Rashtrakuta
(D) Chera

Q.11
Bagurumba is a folk dance of which Indian state?

(A) Haryana
(B) Karnataka
(C) Assam
(D) Goa

Q.12
The number of persons per unit area gives the measurement of _____.

(A) population density
(B) population sex ratio
(C) population movements
(D) population growth rate

Q.13
'Ambubachi' festival of Assam is celebrated in the month of _____ every year.

(A) March
(B) December
(C) January
(D) June

Q.14
Harshavardhana (r. 606-647 CE) was a ruler of _____ dynasty.

(A) Mughal
(B) Maurya
(C) Gupta
(D) Pushyabhuti

Q.15
All India Muslim League was formed in _____.

(A) 1906
(B) 1910
(C) 1905
(D) 1908

Q.16
All the changes in the weather are driven by the _____.

(A) moon
(B) sun
(C) stars
(D) Jovian planets

Q.17
The HVJ gas pipeline from Hazira in Gujarat to Jagdishpur in Uttar Pradesh passes through which state?

(A) Jharkhand
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Himachal Pradesh
(D) Uttarakhand

Q.18
Tapeworm belongs to which group of the animal kingdom?

(A) Annelida
(B) Platyhelminthes
(C) Porifera
(D) Coelenterata

Q.19
Which of the following is an Indian game of snake boat race?

(A) Kho-Kho
(B) Vallam kali
(C) Mallakhamb
(D) Field hockey

Q.20
The judiciary has the power to strike down particular laws passed by the Parliament if it believes that these are a violation of the basic structure of the Constitution. This is called _____.

(A) judicial review
(B) dispute resolution
(C) judicial activism
(D) public interest litigation

Q.21
Who among the following won a silver medal in the Summer Olympics 2020 (played in 2021)?

(A) Ravi Kumar Dahiya
(B) Bajrang Punia
(C) Lovlina Borgohain
(D) PV Sindhu

Q.22
Who became the new Chief Minister of Punjab in March 2022?

(A) Navjot Singh Sidhu
(B) Amarinder Singh
(C) Bhagwant Mann
(D) Arvind Kejriwal

Q.23
Which of the following gases shields the surface of earth from ultraviolet (UV) radiation from the sun?

(A) Carbon monoxide
(B) Ozone
(C) Oxygen
(D) Carbon dioxide

Q.24
Which of the following is an example of contact force?

(A) Electrostatic force
(B) Muscular force
(C) Gravitational force
(D) Magnetic force

Q.25
Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma is known for which classical dance form?

(A) Manipuri
(B) Kuchipudi
(C) Odissi
(D) Mohiniyattam

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (C) Massive

'Bulky' means large and heavy, taking up a lot of space: 'massive'. 'Scanty' and 'airy' point the other way.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Hardly had he disappeared when her mother

'Hardly' is followed by 'when', not 'that': 'Hardly had he disappeared when her mother clomped down the steps'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) suitable

To be 'suitable for' a task is to be right for it. 'Worthy' takes 'of' and 'entitled' takes 'to', and one is 'comfortable with' a task rather than 'for' it.

Q.4 · Answer (B) have a moment

To 'have a moment to spare' is to have a little free time: if there is time before the bus, the listener should drop in.

Q.5 · Answer (C) began writing on

The second verb must be simple past like 'nodded': 'began' ('begun' is the past participle). One writes 'on' a pad: 'began writing on his pad'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) No substitution required

The simple past 'saw' is right for people seen on a past occasion ('on our way back'), so no substitution is needed. 'Seen' alone needs a helping verb, and 'have seeing' is not a verb form.

Q.7 · Answer (A) a bike dropped off

'Bike' begins with a consonant sound, so it takes 'a', and to 'drop off' something is to leave it somewhere: 'a bike dropped off the box'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Genius

A 'maestro' is a master of an art, especially music, a person of outstanding skill: 'genius'. 'Novice', a beginner, is nearly its opposite.

Q.9 · Answer (D) the days had pass

After 'had' the past participle is needed: 'the days had passed'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) To cause disruption or confusion

To 'raise a dust' is to cause a disturbance or confusion, stirring things up as a cloud of dust would.

Q.11 · Answer (A) No sooner had she taken a few steps forward than

'No sooner' pairs with 'than', not 'that', and when a sentence opens with it the auxiliary comes before the subject: 'No sooner had she taken a few steps forward than she suddenly recoiled.'

Q.12 · Answer (D) breathlessly

A messenger hurrying in with news would enter 'breathlessly', out of breath. 'Comparably', 'relatively' and 'enjoyably' make no sense here.

Q.13 · Answer (B) No error

The sentence is correct: the plural subject 'Hundreds of migrants' takes the plural verb 'work', and 'in private firms in Erode' is idiomatic.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Can we all

The subject needs the subject pronoun 'we', not the object pronoun 'us', with 'all' after it: 'Can we all sleep in the same room, Mother?'

Q.15 · Answer (C) Neither she not I

'Neither' pairs with 'nor', not 'not': 'Neither she nor I am going'. ('Am' agrees with 'I', the nearer subject.)

Q.16 · Answer (C) Fiery
'Fiery' is spelt with the 'e' before the 'r', unlike 'fire'. The others should be 'height', 'believe' and 'foreign'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Solitory
The correct spelling is 'solitary', with an 'a'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) healthy
Daily exercise leads to a 'long and healthy life'. Exercise does not make one 'wealthy', and 'marginal' and 'shrieking' make no sense.

Q.19 · Answer (D) To have an ulterior motive
To 'have an axe to grind' is to have a private reason or hidden motive for acting as one does.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Pretended
'Unfeigned' means genuine or sincere, not pretended, so its opposite is 'pretended'. 'Sincere' and 'genuine' are its synonyms.

Q.21 · Answer (B) universally
He was 'universally' recognised, that is by everyone everywhere, as one of the major dramatists of the modern world.

Q.22 · Answer (B) awarded
A prize is 'awarded' to someone: 'he had also been awarded the 1936 Nobel Prize'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) any
'Any other playwright' means every other one: more people have read his plays than those of any other playwright, the two named apart. 'None', 'few' and 'some' do not make this comparison.

Q.24 · Answer (D) cruelty
'Alternated with touching kindness' needs a contrasting quality: 'cruelty', which fits a man 'hard as nails' one moment and sentimental the next.

Q.25 · Answer (C) understand
The sentence turns on understanding both: 'To understand his work you must understand the man'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (D) 0
After interchanging the signs: 200 + 100 – 300 + 200 ÷ 10 × 2 – 40 = 200 + 100 – 300 + 40 – 40 = 0.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 3 and 4
Interchanging 3 and 4 gives 27 – 8 × 3 – 4 ÷ 2 = 27 – 24 – 2 = 1.

Q.4 · Answer (C) #
'Blue' is the only word in both messages and '#' the only code in both, so 'blue' is written as '#'.

Q.5 · Answer (D) NGPVUPE
The letters in the 2nd, 4th and 6th places move 2 forward and the others stay: TACKLE → TCCMLG and JACKET → JCCMEV. So NEPTUNE → N G P V U P E: NGPVUPE.

Q.6 · Answer (C) (13, 169, 2197)
The set is a number, its square and its cube: 7, $7^2 = 49$, $7^3 = 343$. Likewise 13, $13^2 = 169$ and $13^3 = 2197$. (625 is 5^4, 11^3 is 1331 and 3^3 is 27.)

Q.8 · Answer (B) Chess
Each player is paired with their sport: Virat Kohli with cricket, Saina Nehwal with badminton and Viswanathan Anand with chess.

Q.10 · Answer (B) TGJ
The cluster is reversed and each letter moved 2 forward: LOB → B O L → DQN. So HER → R E H → TGJ.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 572
The differences are 9, 11, 13, 15, rising by 2: 557 + 15 = 572.

Q.13 · Answer (D) D
B beats only G, so G is last and B sixth, with C just above B. Of D, E, A and F in the top four places, E and A score below F, and F is not the highest, so D scored the highest.

Q.14 · Answer (D) YJISR
Each word is reversed and every letter moved 5 forward: GRSTB → B T S R G → GYXWL and HANDS → S D N A H → XISFM. So MNDET → T E D N M → YJISR.

Q.16 · Answer (D) TUHQ
The first two letters move 1 forward and the last two 1 back: GEFS → HFER and IBIS → JCHR. So STIR → TUHQ.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Only conclusion I follows
'Some M are Q' converts to 'some Q are M' (I). Nothing links M to V, so II need not follow.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Only conclusion II follows
All hexagons are pentagons and all pentagons are octagons, so all hexagons are octagons (II). I reverses the 'all' statements, which does not follow.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 0
The differences are −1, +4, −9, +16, −25, +36: the squares 1^2 to 6^2 with alternating signs. The next is $-7^2 = -49$, and 49 − 49 = 0.

Q.20 · Answer (C) ECIBGRE
The first three letters and the last three are each reversed and the middle letter stays: ACQ U IRE → QCA U ERI. So ICE B ERG → ECI B GRE: ECIBGRE.

Q.21 · Answer (C) P
O sits at one end. M, N and Q sit together with N in the middle, and P is in neither end seat, so P must sit next to O, with M, N and Q filling the other end.

Q.23 · Answer (C) OUA
Each cluster is three vowels in order, starting one vowel later each time and wrapping round from U to A: AEI, EIO, IOU, OUA.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 864
Each second number is 24 times the first: 3 × 24 = 72 and 21 × 24 = 504. So 36 × 24 = 864.

Q.25 · Answer (D) B4 and B6
Going round to the left from B7 the seats are B7, B2, B5, B1, B4, B3, B6: B1 is third to B7's left, B4 just left of B1, B2 second to B6's left, and B5 is kept away from B6. B3 sits between B4 and B6.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Part IV
The Directive Principles of State Policy are in Part IV of the Constitution, Articles 36 to 51. Part III holds the Fundamental Rights.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Kishore Kumar
Kishore Kumar was one of Hindi cinema's best-known playback singers and also acted in many films. Pranab Mukherjee was President of India and Sunil Chhetri is a footballer.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Lavender Revolution
The Purple Revolution is the spread of lavender farming in Jammu and Kashmir under CSIR's Aroma Mission, so it is also called the Lavender Revolution, after the crop's purple flowers.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded the Brahmo Sabha, later the Brahmo Samaj, in Calcutta in 1828. Swami Dayanand Saraswati founded the Arya Samaj.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Migration from rural areas
Migration from villages to towns is mostly a result of rural poverty, as people leave in search of work, rather than a cause of it. Few jobs outside farming, illiteracy and lack of capital all keep rural households poor.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Finance Minister
The Financial Stability and Development Council, set up in 2010, is chaired by the Union Finance Minister; its members include the heads of the financial regulators such as the RBI and SEBI.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Shashi Tharoor
'The Great Indian Novel' (1989), which retells the Mahabharata as the story of India's freedom movement, is by Shashi Tharoor.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Both I and II
Indian temple architecture has two main styles, Nagara in the north and Dravida in the south, so both statements are correct.

Q.9 · Answer (A) horsts
Block mountains form when faulting lifts some blocks of the crust and lowers others: the uplifted blocks are horsts and the lowered ones grabens.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Rashtrakuta
Dantidurga founded the Rashtrakuta dynasty in the mid-8th century, overthrowing his overlords, the Chalukyas of Badami.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Assam
Bagurumba is a folk dance of the Bodo people of Assam.

Q.12 · Answer (A) population density
Population density is the number of people per unit area, usually given per square kilometre.

Q.13 · Answer (D) June
The Ambubachi Mela is held every June at the Kamakhya temple in Guwahati, Assam.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Pushyabhuti
Harshavardhana belonged to the Pushyabhuti (Vardhana) dynasty of Thanesar and ruled from Kanauj.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 1906
The All India Muslim League was founded at Dhaka in December 1906.

Q.16 · Answer (B) sun
The sun's heat drives the weather: it warms land, sea and air unevenly, which brings about winds, evaporation and rain.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Madhya Pradesh
The HVJ gas pipeline is named after its three points: Hazira in Gujarat, Vijaipur in Madhya Pradesh and Jagdishpur in Uttar Pradesh.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Platyhelminthes
The tapeworm is a flatworm, in the phylum Platyhelminthes. Annelida are segmented worms such as the earthworm, Porifera are sponges and Coelenterata include Hydra.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Vallam kali
Vallam kali is Kerala's traditional boat race, rowed in long 'snake boats'. Kho-kho and mallakhamb are land sports.

Q.20 · Answer (A) judicial review
Judicial review is the courts' power to strike down a law that violates the Constitution, including its basic structure.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Ravi Kumar Dahiya
Wrestler Ravi Kumar Dahiya won silver in the men's 57 kg freestyle at Tokyo. Bajrang Punia, Lovlina Borgohain and PV Sindhu won bronze.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Bhagwant Mann
Bhagwant Mann of the Aam Aadmi Party was sworn in as Chief Minister of Punjab on 16 March 2022, after his party won the state's assembly election.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Ozone
The ozone layer in the stratosphere absorbs most of the sun's harmful ultraviolet radiation.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Muscular force
Muscular force acts only when the body touches the object it moves. Electrostatic, gravitational and magnetic forces act at a distance.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Mohiniyattam
Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma is known for reviving Mohiniyattam, Kerala's classical dance, and is often called its mother.

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